government's Communist supporters in Parliament resisted the deal. They argued that it would erode India's nuclear and strategic autonomy and bring India too close to the United States.

In March 2006, during Bush's visit to India, a separation plan that split India's civilian and weapons programmes was announced. Legislation to enable the agreement by the US Congress (what became known as the Hyde Act) was passed, after considerable lobbying by the Indian government, Indian–American community, and US big business. In July 2007, a so-called 123 Agreement that enabled nuclear trade between India and the United States was signed, but efforts then stalled for a year due to political wrangling between the Indian government and its Communist supporters in Parliament. The next year, after the Congress's loss in Uttar Pradesh state elections, alliances shifted, and the Congress-led government managed to secure the support of the Samajwadi Party (SP). In 2008, a vote of no confidence was held in the Indian Parliament and Manmohan Singh survived. Rather unusually, an Indian government had staked its very existence on a major foreign policy decision. [40] As George W. Bush's tenure was coming to an end in late 2008, events proceeded quickly. Within months, India signed a safeguards agreement with the International Atomic Energy Agency for its civilian programme. The culmination of this complex process was a meeting of the Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG) in Vienna in September 2008. Bush and US Secretary of State Condoleezza Rice called up world leaders, while Indian diplomats went on a round-the-world blitz to secure support for an exception by the NSG for India. China remained the last country to hold out, but once isolated it reluctantly agreed to a waiver for India. [41] After thirty-four years, India had broken free from restraints on civilian nuclear and dual-use technology denials by the international community.

The direct material benefits of this hard-fought agreement were not immediately delivered. This was due to several factors, including the Fukushima nuclear accident in Japan (when an earthquake and tsunami caused a shutdown and radiation leak), the passage of nuclear liability legislation in India that placed a significant burden of risk on foreign